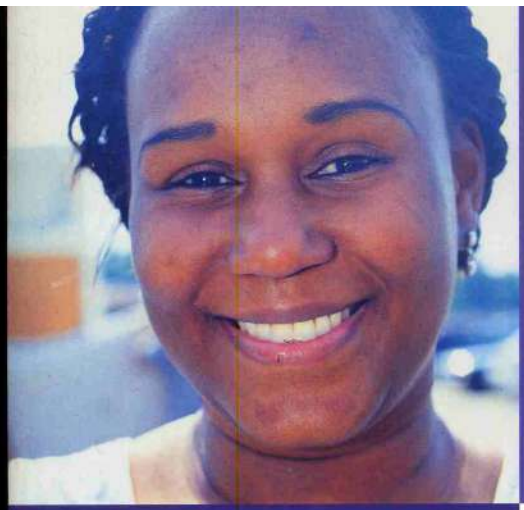
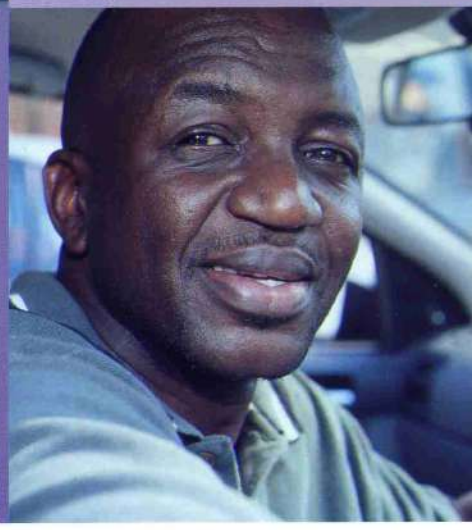










GALLIONS
HOUSING
ASSOCIATION

Gallions Housing Association Limited

Building partnerships for a better Thamesmead

Annual Review 2001

Company address

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London SE2 9XH

T 020 8310 1500
F 020 8310 1811

Freepost service

All tenants and chargepayers can now use the Freepost service to send in their correspondence to the Association. Please quote the following address, also indicating the name of the person or department you are contacting.

Gallions Housing Association
Freepost SE6691
London SE28 9BR

Website

www.gallionsha.co.uk

With thanks to the people of Thamesmead for your help with this report.

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Contents

Chairman's statement	2
Chief Executive's statement	4
Our vision	6
Customer services	8
Rehousing policy	10
Homeowner service	12
Policies and procedures	14
Best Value	16
Customer survey results	18
Performance indicators	20
Development	22
Equal opportunities	24
Resident participation	26
Management Board and Committees	28

Chairman's statement



The first of the key objectives during our first year of trading was to become a Registered Social Landlord. I am pleased to report that Registration with the Housing Corporation was achieved in June 2000.

Gallions aims to be different from its predecessors. I believe, through openness, transparency and inclusiveness, it has already shown a willingness to make a positive difference and improve the prospects for our community. This includes clear management, ambition and growth and working in partnership with other agencies to achieve our objectives.

The Association has sought to affirm its wholehearted commitment to the Best Value initiative as set out by the Housing Corporation and introduced the Customer First project.

Building on the Customer First initiative, a strategy has been prepared for the Association which will shape its future structure and direction. This is primarily a new management structure but also contains recommendations on the technologies and other resources required.

Technologies that are being introduced include Electronic Document Management plus 'Workflow' and 'Scripting' solutions. These technologies will 'direct' users in the Response centres so that there are uniform standards and policies in all our work.

I am very pleased and proud that a development of 30 new rentable homes built for Gallions Housing Association has been completed. The development consists of two and three bedroom houses, including six which are fully accessible for disabled people. These are the first of 71 new properties in the pipeline.

The houses have been built to high quality Housing Corporation standards, standards we intend to maintain in all our future developments. The new houses are located within the second phase of Gallions Reach Urban Village where nearly 280 new homes are being built by private developers for outright sale.

We have commissioned Llewelyn-Davis to begin work on a long-term vision for the Thamesmead area and its community. This will provide a structured framework for improving facilities in the area and increasing the economic and social wellbeing of the population. This is a community-based initiative involving consultation with residents in partnership with Trust Thamesmead, Tilfen and others.

As part of this initiative, the Association has been gathering people's views about how Tavy Bridge could be improved. Suggested improvements, regeneration ideas and questionnaires have been circulated to residents, businesses and workers in the Tavy Bridge area. From this we hope to begin a programme of action next year.

I am pleased Thamesmead is to become home to a ground-breaking project, the development of 39 new eco-friendly, sustainable homes. The six three-bed mobility units, 24 three-bed homes, eight four-bed homes and one two-bed home, include features like solar roof panels, water saving taps, high insulation levels, low temperature heating, individual condensing gas boilers and low flush toilets. The homes are due to be ready in August 2002.

I would like to express my appreciation to staff, senior management and members of the Board for their support and commitment during a difficult transition period.



John Fahy

Chief Executive's statement



It is just over a year since we gained Registered Social Landlord status with the Housing Corporation. Much has been achieved in that short time – but there is even more to do.

We have spent much of this first year repositioning ourselves to respond to the opportunities and challenges that exist to improve the lives of our community. This is not a task that we can take on alone so we have invested time and resources in working with others to develop effective partnerships and ensure lasting improvement.

A tangible example of this is Gallions' sponsorship of Greenwich Community Safety Trust which provides a dedicated Community Safety Project Manager for Thamesmead. Community Safety issues have been identified by our residents as a key priority. One of our first initiatives was to establish the Thamesmead Community Safety Partnership, which aims to work with our community to ensure that people living and working in the area feel more safe and secure.

This, and other priorities, emerged from a comprehensive customer survey undertaken to help us better understand and respond to the needs of our customers. We intend to build on this exercise and establish an ongoing customer panel to provide feedback and a forum for continuing dialogue with our customers.

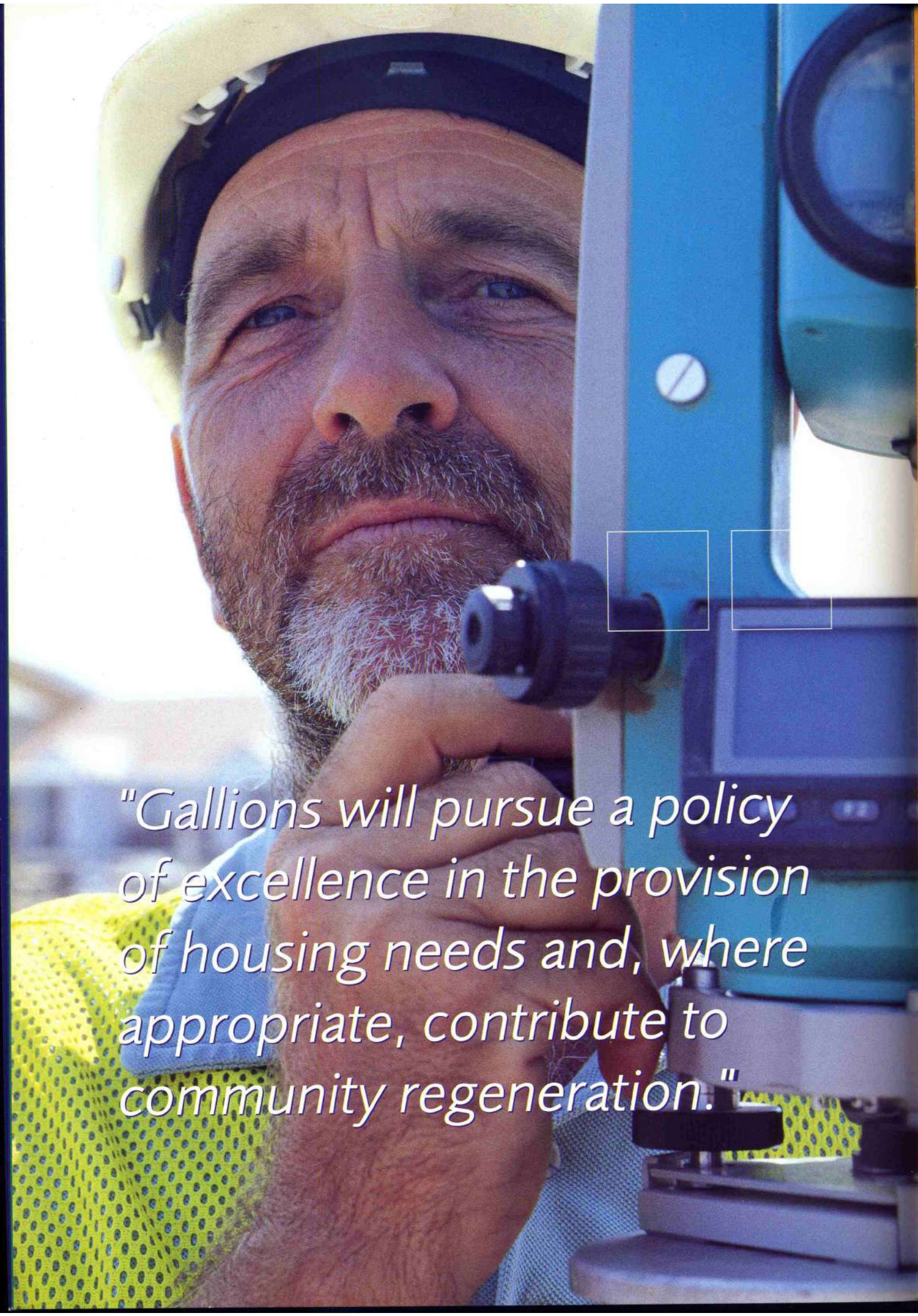
Management of the external environment has also been a continuing priority for our residents. In response we have taken steps to merge some 14 separate contracts such as cleaning, grounds maintenance, graffiti and abandoned cars into one combined contract to provide a better co-ordinated and improved standard of management of the external environment.

These are just a few examples of some of the issues we have begun to address to make a difference to the lives of everyone who lives in, works in, or visits Thamesmead. We are keen to play our part in making things better and are acutely aware that there is much more to be done.

My colleagues and I look forward to this task and are grateful for the support and guidance of the Board. We are also appreciative of the keen interest and contribution of many of our residents, particularly those involved in the Estate Management Boards.



Tony Cotter


"Gallions will pursue a policy of excellence in the provision of housing needs and, where appropriate, contribute to community regeneration."





Our vision

Gallions aims to provide the very best service for its customers by:

- Seeking to work in partnership with all stakeholders.
- Striving for a high level of resident involvement in the services the Association delivers.
- Encouraging a culture of flexibility so as to accommodate change.
- Being financially robust.
- Continuing to seek effectiveness and efficiency in all aspects of its business.

In order to achieve this it will require:

- The initial area of operation be within the Thamesmead area.
- Any envisaged growth be restricted to the South East corner of England.
- The existing property portfolio be appropriately maintained and developed.
- Continuous evaluation and improvement of the services delivered ensuring Best Value is achieved.
- Working alongside Trust Thamesmead and Tilfen to ensure training and employment opportunities are maximised within the community.
- The enhancement of staff skills through appropriate training schemes.
- The enhancement of the skills and understanding of the Board through appropriate training.
- A committed and high-quality level of communication with stakeholders, including staff, local authorities, lenders, contractors and other agencies.



Nobody matters more to us than you, the customer.

That is why we have made customer service our number one priority.

Since gaining registration in June 2000, Gallions Housing Association has set in motion radical reforms to improve the service we deliver.

We have listened to our customers needs and wants and translated them into direct action.

For instance, to provide a more efficient service, we have established a Customer Response Centre and a Customer Service Centre.

We have initiated a five-year plan called FOCUS (Fostering Open Community-based Urban Success) which allows us to improve and upgrade our performance while maintaining a high level of customer service.

We have also made significant investment in new technologies.

It is our aim to become the leading performer in the housing sector in South East London.

To this end, as well as liasing closely with our customers, we have taken a challenging look at ourselves.

Led by a committed Board of Management and a visionary new Chief Executive, our aim is to achieve unrivalled performance in customer service.

Key aspects of our approach to move forward are:

- to sustain an open-minded view of the customers perceptions.
- to continue to seek new ways of developing our capability.
- to take complaints as positive opportunities for improvement.

Our program of change management has become an inherent part of our day to day operational work as we constantly seek to improve our processes and structures and eradicate inefficiencies. To achieve this we have recognised and made investments in new technologies, services, facilities and people as we believe these are all pre-requisites for success.

We have challenged what we do and why we do it, what we want to become and how to achieve unrivalled performance. These were all key factors in re-engineering our organisation to position it in a modern business and commercial setting with an operational structure better geared for strong customer service delivery.

We have also carried out an exhaustive look at the housing sector to establish how the best performers have achieved success and we have firmly grasped the challenges posed by the Best Value initiative and the questions and opportunities set by the DETR Green Paper on Social Housing.

The challenge we face is to achieve the improvements we seek and maintain the momentum of change management whilst at the same time delivering high quality services at the point it matters most, to our customers.

Our five-year FOCUS plan exists alongside our operational teams and activities.

Within FOCUS the most significant element of activity is that geared toward our improvement in the delivery of customer services. This takes the form of a number of high profile customer-based initiatives, investment programmes, Best Value oriented performance improvements, enhanced recruitment packages to attract the best people and ongoing strengthened customer care policies that are strictly monitored.

The Customer Response Centre is a one-stop freephone telephone service which allows customers to enquire about day-to-day matters like repairs or rent queries or lodge a complaint. Callers can get immediate answers and swift action from informed advisors.

For customers who prefer to deal with someone face-to-face, we have custom-built a Customer Service Centre in our Thamesmead offices. This aims to provide a full range of services, advice and information in a welcoming setting. The staff of experience Housing Advisors are qualified to resolve your housing issues.

Both these services are still being developed using customer feedback.

We will also shortly be implementing a full telephone-based customer survey programme. Whenever we have contact with a customer we will telephone them to ask for their views of the level of service they experienced. Feedback will go straight to the teams involved, leading to further improvements in service.

Customer services

striving to be the best





Each of our services is underpinned with significant investment in new technologies. These solutions include:

- Contact Management software to allow us to keep a full record of each interaction with the customer and a full history of the contacts made.
- Telephone call-handling software to allow us to recognise the incoming caller and bring the full property history to our Call Advisers on-screen as soon as the call is received
- Document Imaging to allow us to view correspondence and documents without needing to locate or maintain paper files

All of these solutions are being integrated with our existing comprehensive Housing Management and Accounts systems over the coming year. To these technologies we hope to add more and more internet-ready solutions to enable the customer to access services and information from home or from internet-kiosks at key premises within Thamesmead and Abbey Wood.

In summary, all of these solutions are being implemented and remain the subject of ongoing work for the FOCUS project because we believe in not only satisfying our customers needs but exceeding our customer's expectations.

With this in mind our recruitment program seeks to attract people who not only understand this ethos but wholeheartedly support it. Key appointments to new posts of Customer Services Director and Customer Services Manager will be made. This will strengthen and drive forward our programme of change within the Customer Services department.

At the same time existing staff are being led through a program of culture-change. High profile initiatives have included hard-hitting clean-up campaigns to tackle graffiti and unsightly areas of the housing estates and a full program of Best Value service reviews being run and executed entirely by our own staff.

Although the FOCUS project is still in its infancy and the Association just one year into itπs registration, we have already demonstrated that our vision to be the best of the best through very high quality Customer Services is our highest priority. Our program continues across the entire organisation and there is much work for us to do but, as our services become more mature and our technologies are put to their maximum use, we do not wish to sit back and congratulate ourselves.

It is our vision that we will take our successes, skills and expertise in delivering customer services to a wider customer community by offering our services to others. In doing so we can maximise our revenue potential and plough the returns into further improvements enabling us to exploit other opportunities for the benefit of the community we serve.

To coin a phrase "watching this space" over the next few months and years should prove to be good viewing! We are ambitious and are becoming a growing strength. We still have many weaknesses to address but we have a strong customer-focussed strategy, strong leadership and, we believe, the ability at all levels of our organisation to succeed.



Rehousing policy

In common with all Housing Associations, Gallions is expected to make a percentage of its empty properties available to local authorities. The figures currently stand at 85% to the London Borough of Greenwich and 50% to the London Borough of Bexley. The nomination agreements with both Councils cover all types, sizes and locations of properties.

Gallions no longer has an open waiting list and anyone living outside the area can no longer apply to Gallions. However, if you have lived in Thamesmead for 12 months or more you may apply directly to Gallions. Tenants may also apply for an internal transfer. When a tenant transfers from one Gallions property to another, these properties do not form part of the boroughs nomination agreements.

Properties, (other than nominations) are allocated strictly by priority. The priority points consist of length of time a tenancy has been held, overcrowding, health, exceptional social need and under-occupation. A point is added for every month of registration.

Gallions is part of the HOMES Mobility scheme and may consider a HOMES mobility request for accommodation.

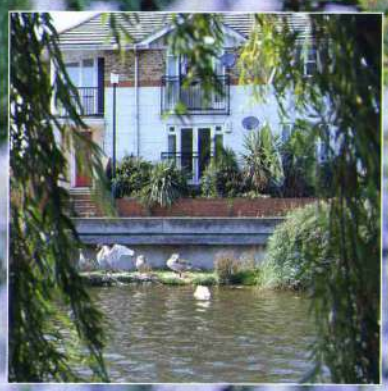
There is a huge demand for all sizes and types of properties and Gallions can no longer give an approximate waiting time.

During the year we have rehoused 418 families, this can be broken down as follows:

External Applicants	212	51%
Transfers and Mutual Exchanges	75	18%
Nominations	131	31%









Homeowner service

Gallions is delighted to announce our new Homeowner Service.

The initiative follows wide and extensive consultations with Freeholders and Leaseholders.

It also underlines our commitement to providing the very best services for our customers.

A Homeowner Focus Group made up of residents will be set up. This will provide us with a valuable insight into the service from your perspective.

Collectively your opinions will lead Gallions to radically look at the way the Homeowner Service is provided. A list of the key recommendations is set out below. They will be implemented in full over the coming months.

Gallions hope you find the new service to be quicker and more responsive to your needs.



- Estate service charges for both freeholders and leaseholders will be withdrawn from the first of April 2001. The layout of invoices and statements will be made clearer and contain more information. The new Estate Service Contract will include service level agreements that will be agreed in consultation with Tenants and Leaseholders. This information will enable you to check that the agreed work is being carried out. Where it is not, Gallions will take immediate action to rectify the problem.

- A dedicated team in the Customer Service Section will manage all Right to buy and Change of ownership applications. This will ensure that specialist staff deal with your paperwork and answer any queries or concerns.

- The Finance department will manage the calculation, invoicing and debt recovery of service charges. This will ensure we deliver a consistent and co-ordinated service with specialist, experienced staff to answer your queries.

- A key set of Performance indicators will be established for all Homeowner services. This includes right to buy, change of ownership and debt recovery.

- All of these Performance indicators will be published on a quarterly basis through *Grapevine*. This will tell you how the service is performing and whether we are meeting your expectations.



- Gallions will establish a Homeowners residents' group through the Association's Tenant participation strategy. This will ensure your views are clearly represented at a decision-making level.

Gallions will revise the Association's Complaint procedure and alert residents to its existence. It is anticipated this will encourage complaints and ensure services are constantly reviewed.

Administration charges will be reassessed to reflect actual costs of service provision.

These recommendations will be implemented over the coming months.



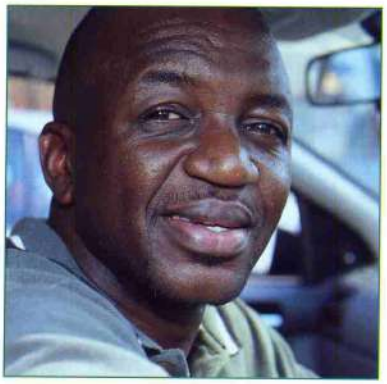
Policies and procedures

Gallions aims to meet the needs and expectations of its customers and service users while providing quality services through well-documented policies, procedures and standards.

There is a comprehensive, in-house policy and procedure manual which includes tenant rights, timescales and targets. It provides easy and instant access for staff to policies, procedures and supporting documents.

These policies and procedures were developed by identifying information on good practice across all housing sectors in consultation with the Policies and Procedures Committee and the Board. Good practice is constantly monitored by Gallions.









What is Best Value?

Best Value is a new Government initiative which requires Housing Associations to review and improve the services they provide for their residents.

Under Best Value, Housing Associations must:

- consult their residents about their services
- compare their services with other service providers
- ensure their services are competitive
- challenge the need to provide services

What is Gallions doing?

Gallions Housing Association has responded to this initiative by establishing a dedicated full time post of Best Value Co-ordinator. The purpose of this role is two-fold:

- To ensure thorough, comprehensive service reviews and deliver genuine improvements.
- To raise and sustain awareness of Best Value within Gallions and the community.

Gallions is committed to supplying the very best service to all our customers. We recognise that to achieve this, we need to become a modern, effective service provider. One of the key changes will be to consult effectively with all our customers. We will ask you important, key questions so that together we can develop a service that really meets your needs.

Types of consultation will include face-to-face customer satisfaction surveys, questionnaires, reply/feedback cards, telephone surveys, full service summaries and focus groups. The type of consultation will depend on the service under review. It is important to us that feedback is actively sought on all possible new initiatives.

Gallions Housing Association is committed to a thorough consultation process – your views and opinions are very important to us.

We want to provide services you want. To do that we need your help.

Best Value comprehensive service review timetable

Extensive research was carried out during the Customer Satisfaction survey in late 2000. Your views enabled us to draw up a timetable of priorities.

Service reviews will be undertaken over a five-year period. At the conclusion of each review a report will be produced with a set of recommendations for service improvements. These improvements will be monitored and tested to ensure the changes are having the desired effect. At the end of the five-year period the cycle will begin again.



Best Value

working for you





Service review	Review date
Environmental management (inc. janitorial and landscape services)	Oct 01 – Jan 02
Estate management (inc. harassment and nuisance)	Feb 02 – May 02
Planned maintenance and capital expenditure	June 02 – Sept 02
Rent collection	Oct 02 – Jan 03
Allocations / Waiting list administration / Voids management	Feb 03 – May 03
Customer service arrangements (all reactive services)	June 03 – Sept 03
Warden services	Oct 03 – Jan 04
Responsive repairs service	Feb 04 – May 04
Development / community renewal services	June 04 – Sept 04
Information technology	Oct 04 – Dec 04
Legal services	Jan 05 – Mar 05
Finance services	Apr 05 – July 05
Corporate governance	Aug 05 – Oct 05
Human resource services	Nov 05 – Jan 06
Office services	Feb 06 – Apr 06
Internal audit	May 06 – July/06
Security arrangements	16/7/06 – Sept 06

Best Value has created an opportunity for both Gallions Housing Association and you to make a real improvement to our services and the Thamesmead environment.

Gallions Housing Association is committed to this Best Value approach.
We hope you are too.

During 2001 face to face interviews with a random sample of customers including both tenants and owners was carried out. The following outlines some of the key results.

This survey was carried out independently by Market Research UK.

Fig 1 shows that a majority of both tenants and owners are also satisfied with their accommodation (84% of all customers), with owners slightly more satisfied with their accommodation than tenants.



Fig 2 shows that almost two-thirds of customers (63%) are satisfied or very satisfied or very satisfied with the overall service they receive from the Association. Owners, however, are less satisfied with services than tenants – 70% of tenants are happy with services, compared to less than half the owners (48%) – and almost a third of owners (31%) are unhappy with services.

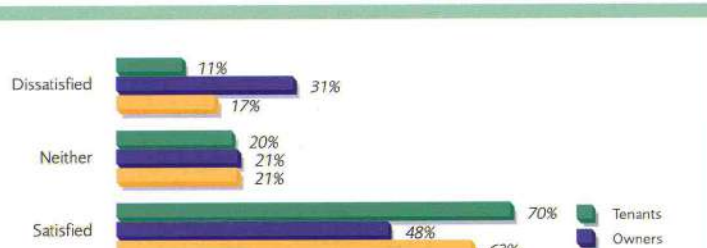


Fig 3 We also asked customers whether they thought the charges they paid to Gallions represented value for money. The chart shows again the different opinions held by owners and tenants – 60% of tenants thought their charges were good value (compared to only 24% of owners), and 16% of tenants thought they were poor value (compared to 46% of owners).

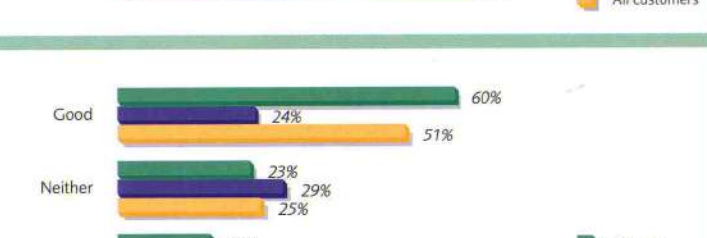
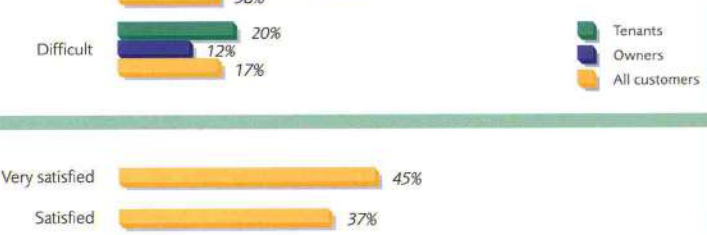


Fig 4 shows that two tenants in every five (20%) have difficulty finding the money to pay their rent, compared to 10% of owners who have difficulty meeting their service charge costs.



Fig 5 shows that the majority of tenants are satisfied with the repairs and maintenance service provided by the Association, with almost half the tenants (45%) stating that they were very satisfied with the service – this is a high score, compared to similar surveys we have conducted.



Customer survey 2001 results

Fig 6 Almost three tenants in every five (59%) had a repair carried out to their home in the last 12 months, of which 40% were inspected prior to work starting, and 9% after the work had been completed. This chart shows how these tenants rated the key attributes of the surveyors who inspected their repair.

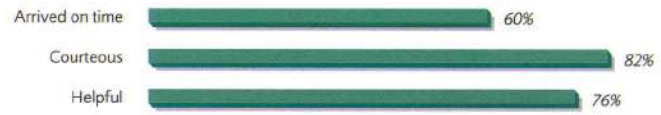


Fig 7 Customer consultation and involvement

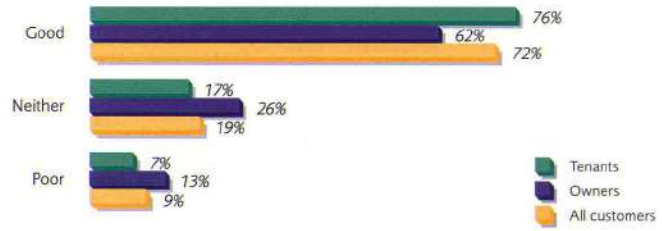


Fig 8 We asked residents a series of questions about the information provided by the Association, and about consultation and opportunities for participation.

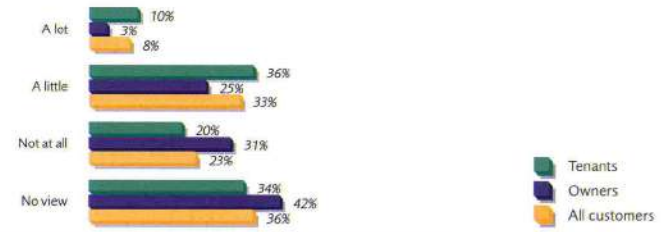


Fig 9 shows how customers felt about the extent to which the Association takes their views into account when making decisions. While most customers did not have a view about this, only 8% of customers (and 3% of owners) thought that the Association took their views fully into account, and almost a quarter (23%) thought that their views were not taken into account at all. Owners are less satisfied with this aspect of the Association's performance than tenants.

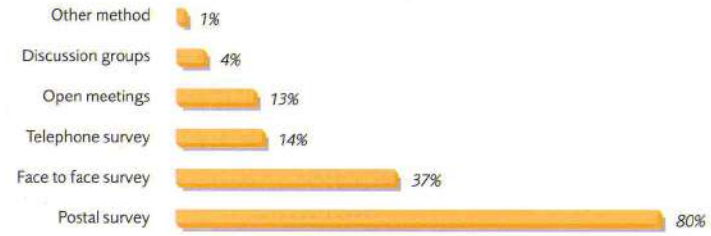
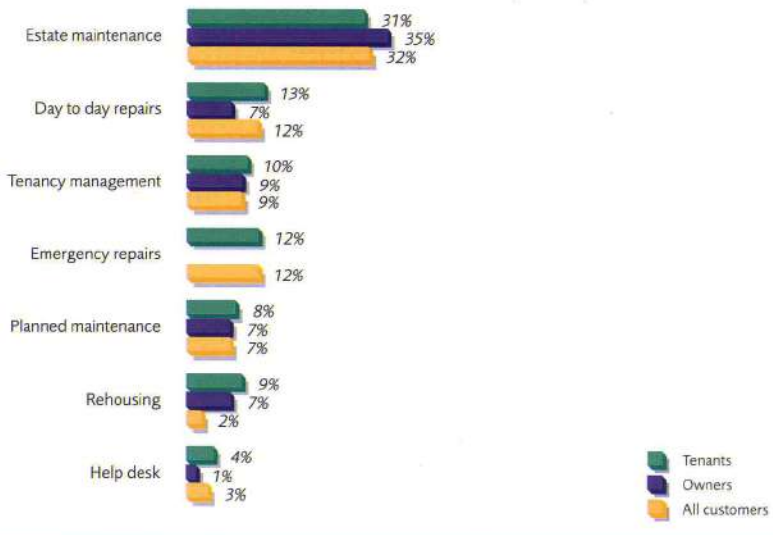


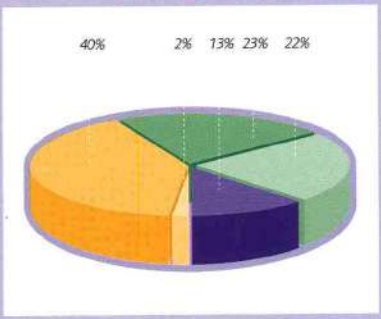
Fig 10 We asked customers to rank the services provided by the Association that they felt should be reviewed first as part of the Association's requirements under Best Value. The chart shows strong support from both tenants and owners for estate maintenance services to be reviewed first, with almost a third of customers (31%) selecting this as a priority. Other services that score high in the rankings for review include day to day repairs and the management of tenancies and leases.



Performance indicators

Stock

The number of housing units managed by Gallions has remained relatively stable: at the end of 2000/01 we had 4,497 units, compared with 4,544 the previous year. Of these, 90 (2%) are bedsits, 1,817 (40%) are one-bedroom flats, 1,007 (22%) two-bedroom flats, 1,022 (23%) three-bedroom flats and 561 (13%) have four or more bedrooms. Our housing units are almost evenly divided between the London boroughs of Greenwich and Bexley: 47% and 53% respectively.



Rent

For the vast majority of our tenants there have been no rent increases since the end of 1999. The total rent roll during 2000/01 amounted to over £17 million. This total includes a proportion of charges other than rent: 12% service charges, 3% fuel charges and 2% of other charges (garages/repairs).

Rent arrears

Rent arrears are a significant issue for Gallions, although they have increased, our arrears figures are well within the average figures for large and London-based registered social landlords. We have developed a rent arrears strategy and action plan to ensure the problem of tenant arrears is systematically addressed.

Rent arrears increased significantly during the year from £847K as at end March 2000 to £996K at end of March 2001. This represents a 17.5% increase.

Arrears as a percent of debit rose from 4.24% to 5.88%.

After allowing for outstanding housing benefit arrears rose from £665K to £790K, or 3.93% of debit to 4.66% an increase of 18.5%.

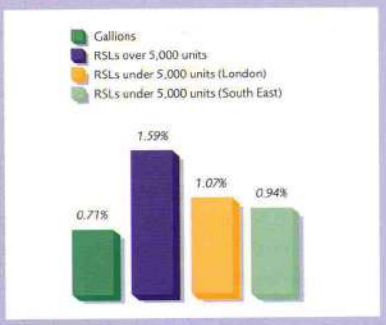
Arrears as a percent of debit can be compared to other RSL's as follows.

Gallions	5.88%
RSLs over 5000 units	6.36%
Top 25%	4.92%
RSLs under 5000 units	
London	9.56%
Top 25%	6.14%
RSLs under 5000 units	
South East	4.57%
Top 25%	3.17%

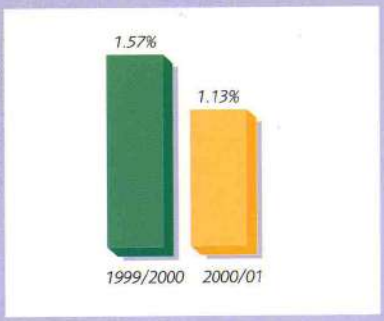
Empty properties

We have continued to reduce the number of empty properties. The average of empty units fell from 52 per month in 1999/2000 to 32 during 2000/01. This compares very well with other registered social landlords (RSLs):

Gallions	0.71%
RSLs over 5,000 units	1.59%
RSLs under 5,000 units (London)	1.07%
RSLs under 5,000 units (Sth East)	0.94%



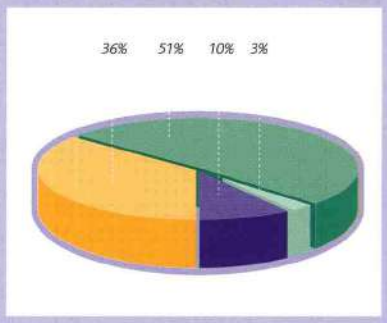
We were also able to reduce the average period to re-let empty properties, from 4.78 weeks in 1999/2000 to 4.52 weeks in 2000/01. As a result, the amount of rent lost as a result of empty properties has also reduced: from 1.57% to 1.13% .



Waiting list

At the end of 2000/01, a total of 811 applicants were on our waiting list. This total can be broken down as follows:

External applicants	415	51%
Internal transfers	291	36%
Thamesmead residents	80	10%
Others	25	3%

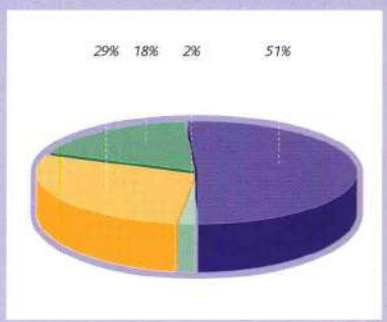


Lettings

During 2000/01 fewer properties were available for letting, because fewer properties were vacated. The total of new tenancies was 418 during the year, compared with 530 during 1999/2000. A substantial number of new tenants (121) were referred to Gallions by Greenwich and Bexley local authorities, with whom we have nomination agreements.

The lettings can be broken down as follows:

Applicants	212	51%
Transfers/Exchanges	75	18%
LA Nominations	121	29%
HOMES	10	2%



Equal opportunities

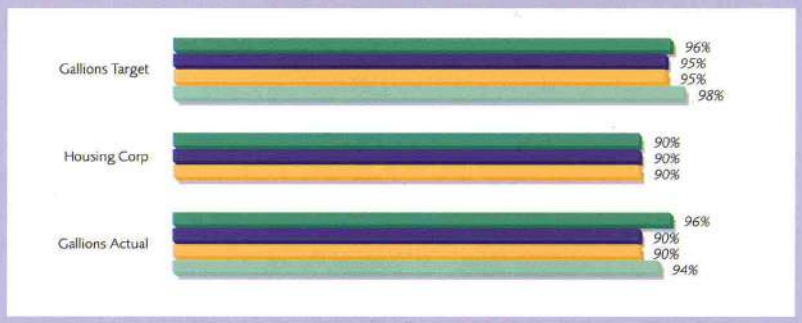
Our points-based lettings system works strictly on a 'top-of-the list' basis and does not differentiate between ethnic groups. However, the percentage of Gallion tenants housed by ethnic group is well within the ethnic groups representation in the Thamesmead locality.

Repairs

Over 23,000 repair jobs were completed during 2000/01, at a total cost of over £2 million. Repair satisfaction levels exceeded our target of 99%.

Vandalism, graffiti, criminal damage and damage caused by tenants took up a substantial proportion of total expenditure on repairs: approximately £180,000, or 8%.

Whilst in all categories performance was above the targets set by the Housing Corporation the completions for urgent, routine and void repairs fell way below the targets set by Gallions.



Planned maintenance

Total expenditure on planned maintenance in the year April 2000 to March 2001 was £2,673,174. This included new windows in 147 homes at an average cost of £3,905 per property under planned maintenance contracts with others renewed on an individual basis where windows were beyond economical repair. Also included in this expenditure were 68 renewed kitchens at an average cost of £2,021 per property in Maran Way as part of a continuing programme.



Development

building homes not just for tomorrow...
but for future generations





Developing from day one

Hardly had the ink dried on the agreement to transfer the stock to Gallions than the first affordable housing development was being planned. Our commitment to the residents of Thamesmead to provide new homes for local people was never better demonstrated than at Gallions Reach Urban Village where we negotiated with local house builder Barratts, to build 30 purpose-built homes for our residents to rent. The scheme, funded entirely by Gallions, was completed this summer. The new homes have all the attributes of the earlier stock, like generous space, but are built to the highest standards with modern sustainable materials.

For an Association in its first year, we have been very busy and three more projects are planned to go on site this before the year end. Another four or five are in the pipeline.

The next phase of the development of the Urban Village is our most exciting project to date. It is due to start on site in the early Autumn 2001. This development combines meeting local housing need with truly sustainable homes.

Nobody who has read the papers following the Kyoto conference can be unaware of the need to ensure that we all do what we can to sustain our planet. Not many organisations in Britain have built eco-friendly homes but at Gallions Urban Reach Village, we are to build 39 properties to the latest ecological and sustainable standards.

The homes, which are to be built in four terraces, will surround an attractive and practical courtyard. The first residents are expected to move into this exciting, affordable complex in early 2002.

It is recognised that Holland and the rest of Europe are way ahead in developing Eco friendly homes, so we have taken the best of Dutch and European architecture and design and set it down in Gallions Reach.

This is not a ground-breaking state-of-the-art process. We simply wish to demonstrate how affordable, sustainable building can be achieved and replicated by other RSL's. We plan to share our experiences in developing these homes. We are building The Gallions Exhibition centre which will be open for one year after completion of the project to allow others to visit, see how the project evolved and share our experience.

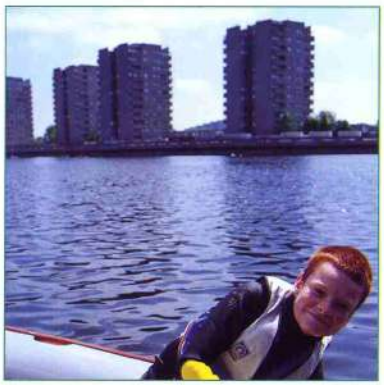
We are creating a 'naked' house – a half completed building, designed to allow visitors to see how the home has been assembled. The whole project features the latest sustainable building materials and features like solar panels, sun spaces to preheat air and reduce energy consumption, heat recovery systems, efficient and sustainable manufactured insulation, highly insulated windows and rainwater harvesting,

This partnering project is with the contractor, Willmott Dixon.

The Urban Village grows
more homes for rent

As the private developers move into the remainder of the Gallions Reach Urban Village, the Association will ensure as many affordable homes as possible are available to the local residents.

As part of a further project, we will start work in winter 2001 to provide 50 homes for rent on another phase of the Village. Although one project, the homes will be set out in three separate groups on the estate and some of the homes will be built to full mobility standards.



Improving estates though partnerships

Regeneration projects will not succeed unless they involve local communities, including the residents, the local authorities, local groups, traders, schools and other services.

We were careful therefore, to include all of these and other local groups, when it came to preparing our redevelopment proposals for Tavy Bridge.

Consultation began at the earliest possible stage and the key issues considered by the residents and Gallions HA were:

- How to make Tavy Bridge a better place for the people who live and work there.
- How to improve the image of Thamesmead as a place to live, work and invest.
- How to demonstrate our joint commitment to Thamesmead.
- How to make Tavy Bridge easier to maintain which will save money and keep rent rises to a minimum
- How to tackle crime and boost security.







The consultation period is nearly over and now our architects, Steven Waldron of SDL, have the task of working with the Gallions staff and converting a vision into reality.

And it doesn't stop there. The next task is to build on the relationships we have formed with local residents and groups to set up effective workshops and forums to keep the dialogue going.

Forming strong links

Developing new homes and refurbishing our existing stock requires us to work with a wide variety of organisations. Over the past year we have developed relationships with many new groups. Most importantly we are now part of the network that meets to discuss and decide local housing issues with our colleagues in the Boroughs of Bexley and Greenwich.



Equal opportunities

Gallions is committed to the principle of equal opportunities both as a landlord and an employer.

As well as accepting its responsibilities under the Sex Discrimination Act 1975, The Race Relations Act 1976 and the Disability Discrimination Act 1995, Gallions Housing Association is committed to broad principles of social justice and is opposed to any form of discrimination. It confirms that equal opportunity extends into all the services it provides (including those provided by contractors on its behalf) as well as its employment policies and practices.

Policies relating to harassment and related racial harassment and associated procedures will aim to produce an effective response to incidents of harassment. This will be dealt with very seriously and is reinforced by the inclusion of a clause making harassment a specific breach of the tenancy agreements.

BME policy

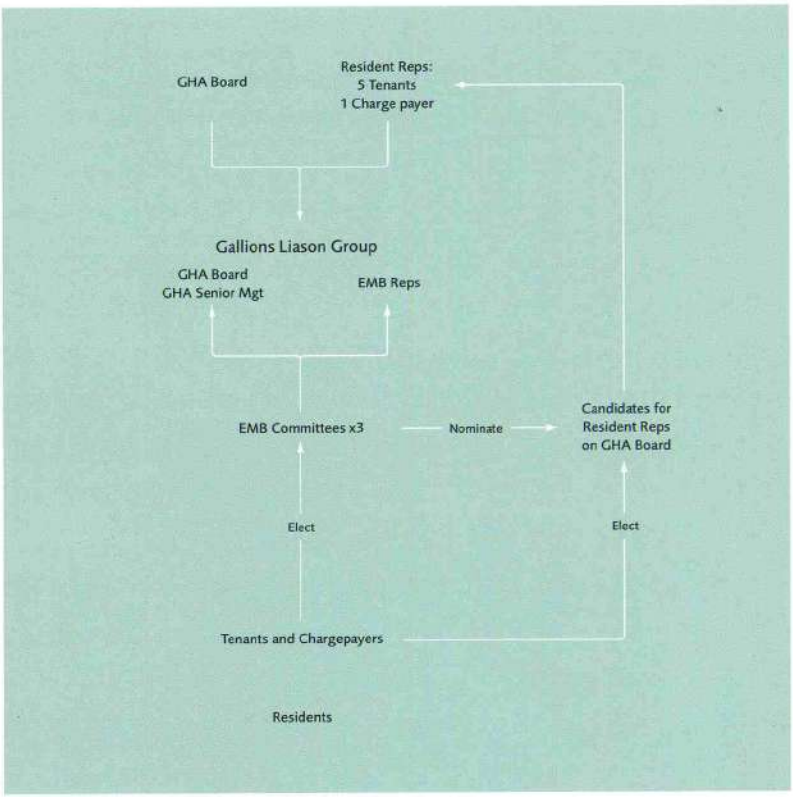
In response to the Housing Corporation's paper 'A question of diversity', Gallions Housing Association has developed a Black & Minority Ethnics strategy and action plan. The plan presents a programme of activities to promote BME representation within the Association's Board composition, employee profile, in the delivery of housing services, development activities and in our corporate image.







Resident participation





Gallions is committed to working closely with our tenants and charge-payer residents and involving them in the decision-making process.

Each resident, tenant or charge-payer, is invited to get involved and have a say in what happens in their neighbourhood.

Three Estate Management Boards are already in place. Five tenant and one charge-payer representatives from the EMBs are elected to the Board of the Association. To ensure the Boards are operating effectively and efficiently, a review of their work is being carried out.

We have also established the Gallions Liaison Group which is made up of representatives from the Estate Management Boards and representatives from the Association's Board and Senior Management. The main role of the Liaison Group is to discuss, consult and agree Thamesmead-wide policy issues and priorities.





We promised and we delivered

The Estate Management Boards are divided into three areas. They are:

Marshes EMB (1)
Waterfield, Moorings and Broadwaters

Ridgeway EMB (2)
Manorway, Crossway, Southmere and Greenmead

EMB (3)
Lesnes and Parkview

Some of the schemes achieved in the last year.

- Manorway Park in partnership with Groundwork
- Mosaic at Binsey Walk and Limestone Walk, which is also a skills work course for young people
- Paving and planters at Limestone Walk
- Planting trees shrubs in Hasler Close
- Better security at Arnott Close
- A rolling programme of security work in each area
- Privatisation of property fronts at Portmeadow Walk
- Play area at Binsey Walk and painting football markings
- Remove old play area at Nassau Path and replace with shrubs and flowerbeds
- Remove wall and replace with barrier in Wren and Widgeon Path. Landscape area
- New litter bins throughout Lesnes and Parkview
- Property fronts enclosed in Holstine and Mangold Way

Members of the Tenants and Residents Association have an important role in helping the EMB's allocate their budget. The budget is for enviornmental improvements which can range from improved lighting or security to extra cleaning of communal areas.

Wherever there is a problem the EMB's will try to resolve it. More than that, you will be involved in finding the best solution and ensuring we get it right first time.

The EMB's budget is limited so you may not get what you want immediately, but all ideas are welcome.

As more and more Tenants and Residents Associations start to form within Thamesmead, you will find that you will have a greater say in what happens to your home and area.

There are many reasons for you to get involved.

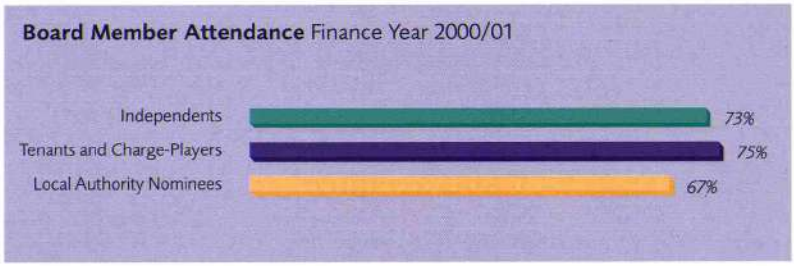


Management Board 2000/20001

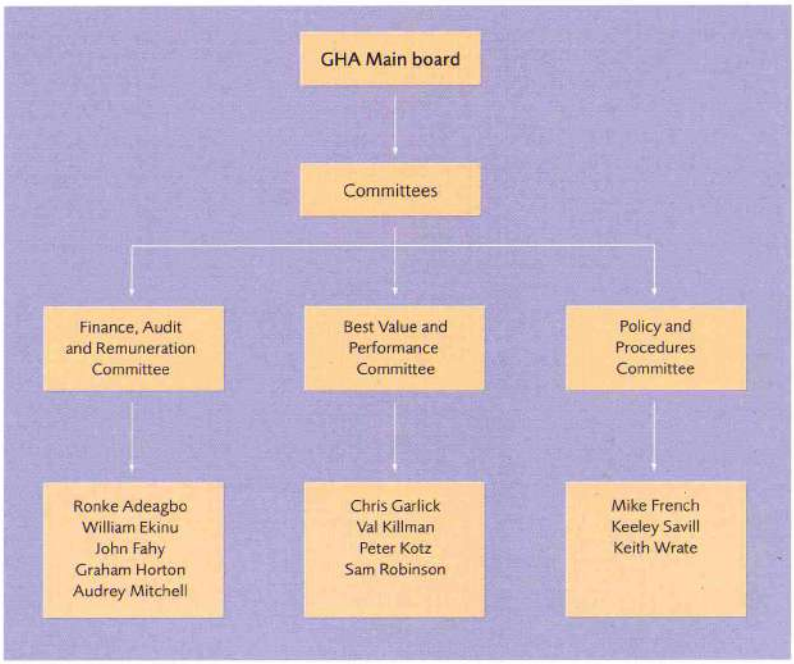
Tenants and Charge-payers
Tony Cox
Graham Horton
Valerie Killman
Michael Ofori
Sam Robinson
Keeley Savill

Local Authority Nominees
John Fahy
Mike French
Graham Holland
Peter Kotz

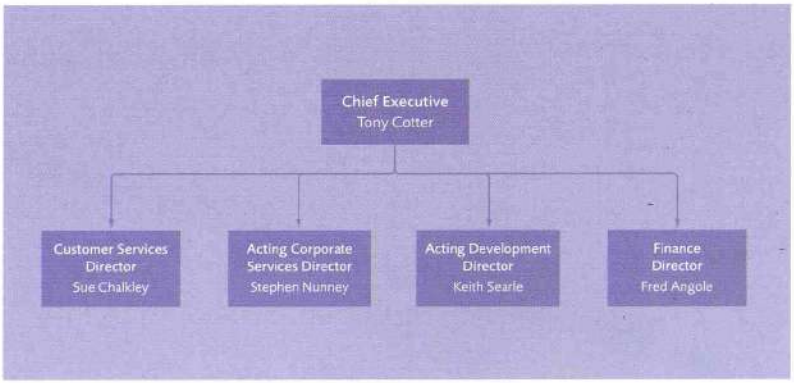
Independent Board Members
Ibironke Adeagbo
William Ekinu
Chris Garlick
Audrey Mitchell
Keith Wrate



Committees



Senior Officers





In partnership